

Samsung made Google Nexus S finally goes official, touting Gingerbread and NFC Google Nexus S

So, the much previewed Google Nexus S has finally been officially announced by Google, confirming the specifications, and providing a launch date of December 16th.

The phone will be the first device to be released with the Google Android 2.3 Gingerbread operating system, and platform's SDK has been released as well (for a detailed list of new features, check out our other coverage).

In case you missed the buzz about the device, the Google

Nexus S features a slightly unconventional curved 'Contour' touchscreen, and is an evolution of the Samsung Galaxy S that is supposed to aid ease of use in a touch-based interface.

The phone will also be one of the first commercial devices to support Near Field Communication (NFC), allowing the device to interact with its electronic environment in ways that Google likens to "magic". Some of the expected applications will be various augmented reality functions, as well as



personal identification, mobile "electronic wallet" payment systems, etc.

As you'd expect, the Google Nexus S will not be hitting Indian shores just yet, but it is reasonable that a similar variant of the Samsung Galaxy S i9020 will arrive India. The

current unlocked price state-side of \$529 can give you a very rough idea of the expected price (~ ₹24,000).

Google Nexus One owners will also be glad to know that an Android 2.3 Gingerbread will be heading their way soon, within the next few weeks. **d**

Sharp to bring 3D-capable smartphones to India in 2011

Sharp, the Japanese consumer electronics giant who recently made an entry into the Indian mobility market, has announced it will be bringing in 3D smartphones to India, China, and the United States by 2011, probably in the form

of the recently introduced Galapagos Android handsets, featured below. This information also matches the 4-5 month timeline Sharp had given us for bringing in high-end smartphones into the Indian market, as well as previous indications that Sharp would launch a 3D smartphone

by the end of the year (the Galapagos 003SH is scheduled arrive on Japanese carrier, Softbank's network by December)

While it is not definite that the 3D-capable smartphones Sharp will bring into the Indian market will be the Galapagos 003SH and 005SH handsets, let us take

a look at them to give us a fair idea of what we might soon have in store for us. Both phones are nearly identical, with the 005SH featuring a QWERTY sliding keyboard in addition. Both phones have a 3.8-inch auto-stereoscopic display similar to that on the upcoming Nintendo 3DS portable game console, with a resolution of 800x480 pixels. They will be powered by a 1GHz Snapdragon processor, and run Android Froyo.

While both phones are capable of recording 720p HD video, the 003SH has a 9.6MP camera onboard, while the 005SH has an 8MP camera. **d**

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